

County Council Budget Hearings 2025, Thursday, September 4th, Afternoon Session

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xDFKNtvBcmo
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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

The provided transcript does not contain a statutory public hearing or separate committee work session held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order. (Note: The meeting resumes directly following an earlier recess).

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** 00:00:04 The meeting resumes from a recess to discuss the county budget, specifically beginning with the auditor's budget review and financial updates.
- **Attendance:**
 - *Presiding/Speaking Board Members & Officials:* Identified in the discussion include Brad (Treasurer), Tanya (Chief Deputy Auditor), Matt, Bill, Jessica, Dan, Stephen, Whitney (Staff), Elizabeth (Staff), and Alexis (Staff).
 - *Roll Call:* A formal roll call of all members present and absent was not explicitly stated in this segment of the transcript.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded in this segment of the transcript.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** None recorded in this segment of the transcript.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:00:07 Treasurer's Financial & Revenue Update**
 - **Presenter:** Brad, County Treasurer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The Treasurer presented interest earnings for August (\$270,366), bringing the 8-month total for the year to \$2,024,003. He projected total interest earnings for the year to exceed \$3.1 to \$3.2 million. For the 2025 budget, he recommended raising estimated interest revenue from the originally forecasted \$2,000,000 to \$2,311,000 (an increase of \$311,000, or an added \$600,000 when factoring in adjustments for July<U+2013>December 2025). Additional minor adjustments and projections for 2026 were also reviewed.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Informational update; incorporated into budget revenue calculations.
- **00:30:45 Auditor's Departmental Budget Review (General Fund & Associated Funds)**
 - **Presenter:** Tanya, Chief Deputy Auditor (speaking on behalf of Auditor Ed).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Tanya presented the auditor's office budget request. Key points included a 4% salary increase request (which the council later debated rolling back), an increase driven heavily by employee benefits (\$660,376), and the elimination of a senior platroom deputy position offset by an existing grants and compliance deputy. Discussion also covered high contractual services costs (specifically Baker Tilly accounting/gap reporting fees), software maintenance costs (Guts taxing software, SSI VIP, grant-seeker software), and part-time funding.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Disposition:** The council adjusted various line items (zeroing out overtime and stipends, adjusting part-time funds, and maintaining/reducing certain contractual and software lines pending further review). *Approved by Voice Vote* on individual line-item adjustments.
- **01:43:18 County Council Budget Review**
 - **Presenter:** Council Members (Led by Bill, Jessica, Matt, and Brad).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council reviewed its own departmental budget line-by-line. Discussions focused on office supplies, professional services, contractual services (including live-streaming costs and potential Baker Tilly budget assistance scope), food/lodging, transportation, and training.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.

- **Action & Disposition:** Adjustments were made to office supplies, professional services, and training lines. *Approved by Voice Vote* for the revised council budget totals (\$166,674).
 - **02:12:35 County Council Local Income Tax (LIT) & Pension Funding Discussion**
 - **Presenter:** Bill, Jessica, and Council Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council discussed minimum pension funding requirements, proposing to cover the minimum or midpoint (\$222,541) utilizing LIT revenue. The council also reviewed overall budget gaps, noting approximately \$2.87 million remaining to cut after factoring in departmental give-backs and increased interest revenues.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Informal consensus reached to add \$9,063 to cover the minimum pension requirement. *Approved by Voice Vote*.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No general public comment or citizen forum period took place during this specific segment of the transcript; discussions were strictly confined to board members, elected officials, and staff.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - The council scheduled the continuation of budget hearings for the following day at **10:00 AM** to allow staff time to finalize numbers.
 - Requested attendance for upcoming sessions includes the Treasurer, Commissioners, representatives from the Sheriff's communication center, and the courts.
 - **Adjournment:** **02:26:56** The meeting was placed into recess by a voice vote.
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